TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Explain What Really Happened and Clear Up a Misunderstanding

Explain | PPF | Fix the Misunderstanding

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Clear up a misunderstanding: say what really happened and why, with one example, without blaming anyone, check it is clear, and answer a concern.

WHO You work in accounts. Kumar, from sales, looks after a hardware shop in Kulai, one of your bigger customers.

SITUATION On Monday at 10 a.m. the shop emailed you for a copy of their invoice (RM4,860). It went into your spam folder. You found it on Wednesday at 4 p.m., sent the copy at 4.10, and the shop replied 'Received' at 4.30.

NEED It is Thursday. On Wednesday morning the shop told Kumar that nobody answered, so he thinks you ignored their email. The new email system sends some outside emails to spam: two emails from the bank went there last week.

GOAL Clear up the misunderstanding: say what really happened and why, without blaming anyone, check Kumar has it right, and answer his concern.

What Kumar thinks

- You ignored the shop's email
- The shop still has no invoice

What really happened

- Monday 10 a.m.: the email went to spam
- Wednesday 4 p.m.: you found it · 4.10: sent the copy
- 4.30: the shop replied 'Received'
- Why: the new email system (two bank emails in spam last week)
- Now: you check your spam folder every morning

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Kumar asks: “Hey, the Kulai shop called me yesterday. They say you never answered their email! Why did you ignore them?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

Kumar, I think there’s a misunderstanding about the Kulai shop. I didn’t ignore their email. It went into my spam folder, and I found it on Wednesday at 4 p.m. It went there because our new email system sends some outside emails to spam. For example, two emails from our bank went there last week too. So the shop waited two days, and I’m sorry about that. But they have the copy now: I sent it at 4.10. Now I check my spam every morning. It wasn’t anybody’s fault: it was the spam folder. Is that clear? Can you tell the shop that when you call them?

P PAST · WHAT REALLY HAPPENED

P PRESENT · WHY, FOR EXAMPLE

F FUTURE · NOW AND FROM NOW ON

! CHECK · CLEAR IT UP

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Siti clears up a misunderstanding about claim forms. Order: Past → Present → Future → Check.

- [ ] Mei Ling, I think there's a misunderstanding. I didn't miss the deadline: I gave the 14 claim forms to Mr. Tan on Friday.
- [ ] He's signing them now, so you'll have them by 4 p.m. today.
- [ ] So nobody forgot them. Is that OK for the salaries, or do you need them earlier?
- [ ] They're still with him because he was in Penang until this morning. For example, Kumar's claim is waiting too.

Write the letter: **P** = Past · what really happened · **P** = Present · why, for example · **F** = Future · now and from now on · **!** = Check · clear it up

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SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

NAME THE MISUNDERSTANDING

- [ ] I think there's a misunderstanding about …
- [ ] I didn't ignore …
- [ ] Actually, I …
- [ ] It wasn't like that.

WHAT REALLY HAPPENED

- [ ] What really happened is …
- [ ] First …, then …
- [ ] I found it only on …
- [ ] It happened because …

EXAMPLE, AND NO BLAME

- [ ] It wasn't anybody's fault.
- [ ] It was a mix-up.
- [ ] For example, …
- [ ] It happens with … too.

CHECK

- [ ] Is that clear?
- [ ] Shall I say that again?
- [ ] So it was …, not …, okay?
- [ ] Does that make sense?

ACKNOWLEDGE AND RESPOND

- [ ] You're right, and I'm sorry about that. …
- [ ] I understand your worry. …
- [ ] That's fair. Next time, I'll …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. The shop's email went into my spam folder. [for example, / because / so] I didn't see it until Wednesday.

_____

2. I didn't answer on Monday. [for example, / so / because] The email was in my spam folder.

_____

3. The new system sends some outside emails to spam. [But / If / For example,] Two emails from our bank went there last week.

_____

4. I found the email. [because / First … then … / for example,] I sent the copy ten minutes later.

_____

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. On Monday, the shop's email _____ into my spam folder. (What happened, with a time)
   ○ go ○ going ○ went
2. I _____ ignore your email. (What you did NOT do)
   ○ didn't ○ wasn't ○ not
3. Our new email system _____ some outside emails to spam. (A fact that is still true)
   ○ sending ○ send ○ sends
4. They _____ the copy now: I sent it at 4.10. (How things are now)
   ○ have ○ having ○ has

SLIDE 09

What happened → what is true now

Say what did not happen with didn't + verb. Say what really happened with a past verb and a time. Say why, or how it is now, with the present.

I **didn't ignore** your email.

It **went** into spam **on Monday**, and I **found** it **on Wednesday**.

The system **sends** some outside emails to spam.

The shop **has** the copy **now**.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

PAST · WHAT REALLY HAPPENED

I think there's a misunderstanding about … I didn't … Actually, …

P

PRESENT · WHY, FOR EXAMPLE

It happened because … For example, …

F

FUTURE · NOW AND FROM NOW ON

So … They have / It's … now. Now I …

!

CHECK · CLEAR IT UP

So it was …, not … Is that clear? / Does that make sense?

SLIDE 11 Fix the Misunderstanding

The listener believes something wrong. The speaker says what really happened, why, one example and how things are now, blames nobody, and checks. The listener writes a note, reads it back and raises one concern.

1. Round 1 (3:00). Speaker: say your card number. Listener: say that card's Start line. Speaker: clear it up.
2. Listener: fill the note, ask for any empty line, read it back, say your concern. Speaker: acknowledge, answer.
3. Listeners move one seat. Round 2 (2:00): same card to a new listener, shorter.
4. Round 3 (2:00), frames closed: speakers shut the workbook, card only; listeners keep the note open. Then swap roles.

Card 1 · The stock report

Card 2 · The samples for Batu Pahat

Card 3 · Money for the farewell lunch

Card 4 · The laptop for repair

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
What really happened			
Why + example			
Now			
Blamed anybody? Y / N			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Kumar asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. **But the shop waited two days. That looks bad for us.**
2. **Can this happen with my other customers too?**
3. **You didn't tell me on Wednesday. I didn't know what to say to the shop.**

Start with: **You're right, and I'm sorry about that. … · I understand your worry. … · That's fair. Next time, I'll …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend thinks you ignored her wedding invitation: she sent it by text message three weeks ago. Really, you changed your phone number last month, so it went to your old number. Your cousin's birthday message went there too. You saw the invitation only yesterday. You are free that day and want to go. Clear it up, without blaming anyone.

I think there's a misunderstanding about … · What really happened is … · It happened because … · Is that clear?

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Starts from what the listener believes, then says what really happened; the listener can say it back.
- [ ] Gives the reason and one example, and blames nobody.
- [ ] Acknowledges the listener's concern, then answers it in one or two sentences.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Correcting the belief	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Reason and example, no blame	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Answering a concern	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · The stock report

You are Mr. Tan. You think the stock report is late: it was due on Tuesday at 5 p.m., and your email has nothing. Start: 'Where's the stock report?' Concern: 'Why didn't you tell me?'

Card 2 · The samples for Batu Pahat

You are Kumar. Your customer in Batu Pahat says the samples never came, so you think nobody sent them. Start: 'You forgot my samples!' Concern: 'The customer is upset. What do I tell them?'

Card 3 · Money for the farewell lunch

You are Siti. You collect the money for Friday's farewell lunch. Your list says this person has not paid. Start: 'You still owe me for the lunch!' Concern: 'But now my list is wrong. How do I fix it?'

Card 4 · The laptop for repair

You are Ali. Your laptop must go for repair, but it's still on your desk. You think nobody booked a courier. Start: 'Did you forget the courier?' Concern: 'I need it fixed soon. Can it go today?'

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · The stock report

Example: Kumar's sales report is in that folder too · Now: it's in the shared folder 'Stock reports' · Why: the file is 25 MB, too big for email · Finished: Monday 4.30 p.m., one day early · You didn't send him a message about it

Card 2 · The samples for Batu Pahat

Guard signed for it: Monday, 3.20 p.m. · Now (Wednesday): the box is still at their guardhouse · Example: their order in August waited there two days too · Sent: Monday morning by Fast Go · Why: their office is closed on Mondays

Card 3 · Money for the farewell lunch

Ali has a list of who paid him · Paid: RM25 by e-wallet, Tuesday 1.05 p.m. · Example: Kumar paid Ali too · Why: Siti was out at the bank, and Ali was collecting for her · Now: Ali gives Siti all the money today

Card 4 · The laptop for repair

Driver came at 10.15 · Booked: Fast Go on Tuesday, pickup Wednesday 10 a.m. · Example: a parcel for Kumar went back too · Now: the driver comes again tomorrow, 9 a.m. (the earliest) · Why: fire drill 10 to 10.30, front door locked